

EDS Assignment

PS50008A Research Methods | Term 2 Spring 2026

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12 January 2026

Key Information

Deadline	Friday 20 March 2026, 12 noon
Submission	Via Moodle submission link
Format	Worked statistics assignment
Weight	20%
Pass mark	50%

Task Structure

You will receive a research scenario with actual raw data.

Section A: Statistical Mechanics

1. State the researcher's hypothesis
2. Identify design type, IV, DV, data type
3. Calculate means and SDs
4. Run appropriate statistical tests
5. Interpret results and write up in APA format

Section B: Methods and Theory

6. Suggest TWO methodological improvements
 7. Discuss individual differences / extensions
 8. Propose a more ecologically valid alternative (minimum half page)
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Critical Requirements

Demonstrate Understanding

You **MUST** demonstrate your understanding - not just get the right answer.

- Full marks = right test AND proper justification
- No punitive marking, so if you get something wrong, you just get zero for that item
- You are expected to use the terminology and concepts we have been discussing in class
- Pay attention to the glossaries and readings provided

What “Demonstrate Understanding” Means

Aspect	What we're looking for
Test selection	Why this test? Link to design and data type
Hypothesis	Clear statement with direction justified
Interpretation	What does the result mean in context?
Improvements	Thoughtful, specific, feasible suggestions

Preparation

- Practice with worked examples from labs
- Review APA reporting format for statistics
- Understand the logic behind test selection
- Be comfortable calculating means and SDs by hand